Widows' home outreach

Retrospective terms of reference

Saturday, 12 March 2022 | Muea, Buea

Why we chose this outreach

Our Christian commitment to care for our neighbours calls us to notice needs that can remain hidden behind a front door. Through conversations in the community and with churches, our team sought out widows facing particular hardship, including women caring for children and women whose health or mobility made daily life more difficult. We wanted to respond with useful household supplies and personal encouragement, rather than choose recipients or purchases at random.

Who and what the project was for

The outreach was intended for widows identified through those local enquiries and conversations. Our approach was to listen to each woman, understand the support she needed and arrange a home visit with her permission. Support took the form of goods, not cash grants. The completion report records an approximate reach of 20 widows; this is not an attendance-register count.

Preparation and responsibilities

Our leaders gathered information and brought it back to the team for discussion and agreement on the visit date. Conversations with the women informed the shopping list. Our team arranged purchases, transport and the sequence of home visits. Supplies were to be kept at a nearby staging point and carried to each home in turn, rather than asking women with limited mobility to attend a central distribution.

Delivery approach and care

At each home we would greet our host, offer encouragement, read the Bible and pray, then leave the supplies intended for her. Our faith motivates this service; assistance was available regardless of participation in prayer or worship. Respect for privacy and dignity meant keeping personal health details and recipient names out of the partner report.

Resources and accountability

Our recollection is that about 220,000 FCFA was sent, with withdrawal recalled at 5,000 FCFA and transport at about 10,000 FCFA. These figures give an approximate goods amount of 205,000 FCFA. The companion report separates recalled totals from reconstructed category allocations; individual purchase prices have not been verified. Our usual closing practice is a team discussion of delivery, timing and improvements.

Document basis: Prepared some time after the project was carried out, using our team's account and available working files. This retrospective terms of reference records the purpose and intended approach; it is not an original pre-project authorization.